

# Debbie Amewu

Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina,  
1014 Greene Street, Columbia, SC 29208

LinkedIn: [debbie-amewu](#) | Email: [damewu@email.sc.edu](mailto:damewu@email.sc.edu) | Phone: +1-803-363-7184

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Applied Microeconomics, Law and Economics, Economics of Crime & Public Economics

## EDUCATION

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2022 - PRESENT    Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina, United States  
2019 - 2020        MSc. Economics, University of Warwick, Coventry, United Kingdom  
2014 - 2018        B.A. Economics (First Class), University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana,

## RESEARCH

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### Working Papers

1. “The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia”
2. “Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections”
3. “Do Prison reforms work: Evidence Based on the Justice Reinvestment Initiative”

### Works In Progress

1. “Can Machine Learning Improve Pretrial Risk Assessment? Evidence from Virginia’s Public Safety Assessment”

## SCHOLARSHIPS/AWARDS/GRANTS

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2025    Darla Moore School of Business Research Grant, with Phil Brookins and Cooper Woodham (\$5,000)  
2022    Graduate Assistantship at the University of South Carolina  
2019    Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) Scholarship

## CONFERENCES/WORKSHOPS/SEMINARS

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|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2027 (SCHEDULED) | American Economic Association conference, Washington The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia)            |
| 2026 (SCHEDULED) | Association of Public Policy and Management, Boston, MA (The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia)        |
| 2026 (SCHEDULED) | Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX (The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia) |
| 2025             | Association of Public Policy and Management, Seattle, WA (presented: Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections)                     |
| 2025             | Interdisciplinary Policing Workshop, University of South Carolina, SC (presented: Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections)        |
| 2024             | Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, Clemson University, SC                                                                                                                    |
| 2023             | Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day, University of South Carolina, SC                                                                                                    |

## TEACHING

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### Primary Instructor:

- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2025)
- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2026)

### Teaching Assistant:

- Public Finance ECON562 (Spring 2023)
- Principles of Microeconomics ECON221 (Spring 2023)
- Political Economy ECON516 (Fall 2022)
- Industrial Organization ECON515 (Spring 2023)
- Health Economics HSPM412 (Fall 2023, Spring 2024)

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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### Research Experience

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|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AUG 2024 - APR 2025  | Research Assistant to Dr. Jessica Brown and Dr. Chris Herbst: “Impact of private equity ownership status on child care companies.”                                         |
| AUG 2024 - DEC 2024  | Research Assistant to Dr. Lindsey Woodworth: “The impact of sheriff characteristics on death investigations”.                                                              |
| MAY 2024 - AUG 2024  | Research Assistant to Dr. David Fuente:- Projects involved analysing the impact of various experiments to encourage payment of utility bills in several African countries. |
| MAY 2024 - AUG 2024  | Research Assistant to Dr. Orgul Ozturk                                                                                                                                     |
| MAY 2023 - JULY 2023 | Research Assistant to Dr. Felipe Saenz                                                                                                                                     |

## Professional Experience

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|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020-2022        | Consultant, Credit Administration Department, PwC, Ghana      |
| 2018-2019        | Associate, Advisory LoS, PricewaterhouseCoopers Ghana Limited |
| JUNE - JULY 2017 | Call Centre Intern, Dalex Finance and Leasing Company, Ghana  |

## LANGUAGES

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ENGLISH: Fluent  
AKAN: Native

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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| PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES | Python, LATEX            |
| SOFTWARE              | Stata, zTree, MS Office. |

## REFERENCES

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**Lindsey Woodworth (Committee Chair)**  
Department of Economics  
University of South Carolina  
[lindsey.woodworth@moore.sc.edu](mailto:lindsey.woodworth@moore.sc.edu)  
+1 (803) 777 3602

**Sarah Walfogel**  
Department of Economics  
University of South Carolina  
[sarah.waldfogel@moore.sc.edu](mailto:sarah.waldfogel@moore.sc.edu)  
+1 (803) 544 1271

**Danna Thomas**  
Department of Economics  
University of South Carolina  
[danna.thomas@moore.sc.edu](mailto:danna.thomas@moore.sc.edu)  
+1 (803) 777 4940